



Staff Report

TO: Honorable Mayor and Members of the City Council
FROM: Doug Story, Community Services Director
BY: Brittany Navas, Grants Analyst
DATE: March 17, 2026
SUBJECT: Stewart Park Update and Discussion

Description: Update to the City Council on the Stewart Park Revitalization Project, including the project timeline, federal grant compliance requirements associated with the Outdoor Recreation Legacy Partnership (ORLP) program, current project status, and associated fiscal considerations.

Background and Analysis:

This staff report provides an update on the Stewart Park Revitalization Project, including the project timeline, federal compliance requirements associated with the Outdoor Recreation Legacy Partnership (ORLP) grant, and the City's ongoing efforts to preserve the grant award while completing the required environmental and cultural review processes.

The Stewart Park Revitalization Project is a major capital improvement effort intended to modernize one of the City's historic parks and expand recreational amenities for the Beaumont community. Due to the scale of the improvements and funding limitations, the City structured the project into two phases to allow construction to begin while continuing to pursue additional grant funding opportunities.

In 2024, the City applied for funding through the ORLP program. ORLP is a federally funded grant program administered by the National Park Service (NPS) through the California Department of Parks and Recreation Office of Grants and Local Services (OGALS). The City was selected to receive \$3.1 million in ORLP funding to support Phase II improvements at Stewart Park.

Following selection for the grant, the project entered the federal post-award compliance process. Because ORLP funding is administered through the National Park Service, projects must complete environmental and cultural review requirements under the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) and Section 106 of the National Historic

Preservation Act before construction activities can proceed within the federally defined project boundary.

During coordination with state and federal partners in spring 2025, staff were advised that these federal compliance requirements apply to the entire project area within the park boundary. In order to preserve eligibility for the ORLP grant while the required federal reviews are completed, the City Council directed staff on June 3, 2025, to temporarily pause construction activities at Stewart Park.

Construction activities were halted on June 4, 2025, and the contractor began securing and stabilizing the project site. Construction at Stewart Park remains temporarily paused while the required Section 106 cultural consultation and NEPA environmental review processes are completed. These reviews must be finalized before the National Park Service can issue a final environmental determination and OGALS can authorize the City to proceed with construction.

City staff continue coordinating with state, federal, and tribal partners to complete the remaining compliance requirements and position the project to move forward once approvals are received.

Project Timeline

The following timeline summarizes key project milestones and actions taken during the development of the Stewart Park Revitalization Project.

Planning and Grant Application

- April 5, 2022: City Council awards a professional service agreement to PlaceWorks for landscaping and architectural services for Stewart Park.
- November 2023: City Council approves dividing the Stewart Park revitalization project into two phases to address project funding limitations.
- December 2023: City staff begin evaluating the ORLP funding opportunity.
- April 2024: The City submits an ORLP grant application for Phase II improvements.
- June 18, 2024: City Council approves the first amendment with PlaceWorks to include construction administration services.
- June 18, 2024: City Council awards a construction contract to Act 1 Construction to begin Phase I improvements.
- July 8, 2024: Phase I construction begins.
- September 25, 2024: The City receives notification that it has been selected for a \$3.1 million ORLP grant award.

- October 2024: The project enters the federal post-award process, which requires completion of environmental and cultural compliance reviews prior to construction.

Federal Compliance Coordination

- April 29, 2025: City staff meet with representatives from OGALS and ORLP regarding federal compliance requirements.
- May 23, 2025: The City submits required NEPA and Section 106 documentation to OGALS, including the Cultural Assessment Report, Environmental Evaluation, and Notice of Exemption.
- June 3, 2025: City Council directs staff to temporarily pause construction activities to preserve eligibility for the ORLP grant.
- June 4, 2025: Construction activities are halted and the contractor begins demobilizing the site.
- June 4 – June 19, 2025: The construction site is secured, including fencing, storage of equipment, and stabilization of incomplete work areas. The cost associated with demobilization and site security was approximately \$300,000.

Ongoing Coordination and Project Adjustments

- Summer 2025: City staff continue working with OGALS to ensure alignment with federal program requirements, including revisions to the Phase II scope and budget.
- August 1, 2025: Updated budget narrative and revised project scope submitted to OGALS.
- August 19, 2025: The National Park Service confirms the Soboba Band of Luiseño Indians and the Morongo Band of Mission Indians as consulting parties in the Section 106 cultural review process.
- August 2025 – Present: City staff continue coordinating with state, federal, and tribal partners to complete the required environmental and cultural review processes.
- November 2025: OGALS confirms that the final cultural impacts report is under review with the Office of History Preservation (OHP), and that the City should receive a letter of determination within 30 days.
- December 2025: Based on prior coordination, staff anticipated that the Section 106 review process was nearing completion and that a determination from OHP would be issued in the coming weeks. During this time, City staff continued maintaining communication with OGALS and requesting status updates regarding the review.
- January 2025 – Present: As the review process continued beyond the anticipated timeframe, City staff began coordinating with the offices of Congressman Raul Ruiz and State Senator Rosilicie Ochoa Bogh to provide project updates and seek guidance regarding the federal cultural review process. The City continues coordinating with OHP, OGALS, and NPS regarding completion of the remaining

environmental and cultural compliance requirements. At this time, no additional information or documentation has been requested from the City.

Fiscal Impact:

The temporary suspension of construction activities and extended federal compliance review period have resulted in increased project costs associated with construction shutdown activities, site maintenance, and federal environmental compliance requirements necessary to preserve eligibility for the ORLP grant.

- **Current Construction Costs**

Description	Amount
Original Construction Contract	\$11,369,148.00
Total Approved Change Orders	\$522,593.21
Revised Contract Amount	\$11,891,741.21
Expenses to Date	\$6,135,435.43
<i>Remaining Contract Balance</i>	<i>\$5,756,305.78</i>

- **Cultural & Environmental Review Costs
(in accordance with ORLP Grant Compliance)**

Description	Amount
Initial Project Environmental Analysis	\$10,000.00
NEPA/Section 106 Assessment and Reporting	\$28,765.00
Total Environmental Costs	\$38,765.00

- **Construction Pause/Shutdown Costs**

Description	Amount
Initial Temporary Shutdown Change Order	\$283,751.55
Temporary Shutdown Extension Change Order	\$113,728.00
Total Shutdown Change Orders to Date	\$397,479.55

Recommended Action:

Receive and file; or

Direct staff to take additional action.

Attachments:

- A. Comprehensive Stewart Park Timeline Infographic
- B. Comprehensive Stewart Park Gantt Chart